

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

Below is an extract from an online article about superheroes:

Superheroes – there's just something fascinating about imagining how life would be different if we had extraordinary powers to protect the world from evil. Below are the profiles of three superheroes.

Batman

Batman is the secret identity of Bruce Wayne. When Bruce was a child, his parents were attacked by robbers and killed. After he witnessed the death of his parents, he dedicated his life to being a crime fighter. Unlike most superheroes, Batman does not possess any superpowers. He makes use of his intellect, detective skills, science and technology, wealth and martial arts to fight against crime.

Sailor Moon

Sailor Moon is a typical 14-year old who likes sleeping late and playing video games. Bunny (or Usagi in Japanese), like many superheroes before her, one day discovers she has great magical powers. Wearing a distinctive costume, she races off to save the world from various bad guys, discovering inner strength she never knew she had and...saving the day!

Monkey King

If you think Superman or Spiderman has been around for a long time, think about Monkey King. He has been China's favourite superhero for at least five centuries. He's amazingly strong, he can fly, and he has a few tricks those other superheroes have never heard of. And he's always ready to do battle with demons, dragons and sometimes even the gods.

As members of your school's newly-formed Superheroes Society, your group now has to decide how to get started. You may want to talk about:

- which of the three superheroes would best represent the society
- how to attract new members to join
- what activities the society could organize
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Do you have a favourite superhero?
2. Do you enjoy movies about superheroes?
3. What superpower would you like to have?
4. Do superheroes appeal more to boys or girls?
5. Would your school allow you to organize a Superhero Society?
6. Are superheroes good role models?
7. Why do superheroes continue to be popular?
8. If you had a superpower, would you let other people know about it?